

# POTTY TRAINING COMPLETE SYSTEM

## 3-Day Method, Reward Charts & Progress Tracking

By Daniel Tesfamariam

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## READINESS SIGNS CHECKLIST

Your child may be ready if they show 5+ of these signs:

- ☐ Stays dry for 2+ hours at a time
- ☐ Shows interest in the toilet/others using it
- ☐ Can pull pants up and down
- ☐ Tells you when diaper is wet or dirty
- ☐ Hides to poop (shows awareness)
- ☐ Can follow simple 2-step instructions
- ☐ Shows desire for independence
- ☐ Has regular bowel movements
- ☐ Dislikes feeling wet/dirty
- ☐ Can sit still for 2-3 minutes

Signs checked: \_\_\_\_/10 Ready? ☐ YES ☐ WAIT 2-4 WEEKS

## **PREPARATION (1 Week Before)**

### **Shopping List:**

- Potty chair OR toilet seat insert
- Step stool for regular toilet
- 10-15 pairs of underwear (let child choose!)
- Easy-on/off pants (elastic waist, no buttons)
- Reward stickers or small treats
- Waterproof mattress cover
- Extra cleaning supplies
- Books about potty training (for child)

### **Environment Setup:**

- Place potty in bathroom (or living area initially)
- Put step stool at toilet and sink
- Stock bathroom with books/toys for sitting
- Clear your schedule for 3 full days

# THE 3-DAY METHOD

## DAY 1: Introduction

Morning: Say goodbye to diapers together (throw away/donate)  
Put child in underwear only (no pants easier at first)  
Every 15-20 minutes: 'Let's try sitting on the potty!'  
Watch for signs: squirming, holding, hiding, stopping play  
CELEBRATE every success - even just sitting!  
Accidents WILL happen. Stay calm: 'Oops! Pee goes in the potty.'  
Fluid loading: extra water/juice = more practice opportunities

## DAY 2: Building Awareness

Extend time between reminders to 30 minutes  
Ask: 'Are your underwear dry? Let's keep them dry!'  
Child may start self-initiating today  
Fewer accidents expected but still normal  
Short outing (30 min max) with potty reminder before leaving

## DAY 3: Independence

Let child take the lead - remind less often  
Longer outing with portable potty or planned bathroom stops  
Practice pants up and down independently  
Handwashing routine established

## REWARD CHART

Place a sticker for each success!

DAY 1: [ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ]

DAY 2: [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ]

DAY 3: [ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ]

DAY 4: [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ]

DAY 5: [ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ]

DAY 6: [ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ]

DAY 7: [ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ]

MILESTONE REWARDS:

5 stickers = \_\_\_\_\_

10 stickers = \_\_\_\_\_

20 stickers = \_\_\_\_\_

Full week dry = \_\_\_\_\_

## WEEKLY PROGRESS TRACKER

Week of: \_\_\_/\_\_\_/\_\_\_ to \_\_\_/\_\_\_/\_\_\_

MON: Successes: \_\_\_ Accidents: \_\_\_ Initiated: [ ] Dry nap: [ ]

TUE: Successes: \_\_\_ Accidents: \_\_\_ Initiated: [ ] Dry nap: [ ]

WED: Successes: \_\_\_ Accidents: \_\_\_ Initiated: [ ] Dry nap: [ ]

THU: Successes: \_\_\_ Accidents: \_\_\_ Initiated: [ ] Dry nap: [ ]

FRI: Successes: \_\_\_ Accidents: \_\_\_ Initiated: [ ] Dry nap: [ ]

SAT: Successes: \_\_\_ Accidents: \_\_\_ Initiated: [ ] Dry nap: [ ]

SUN: Successes: \_\_\_ Accidents: \_\_\_ Initiated: [ ] Dry nap: [ ]

Notes: \_\_\_\_\_

## **TROUBLESHOOTING COMMON ISSUES**

### **Refuses to sit on potty:**

- Don't force! Let them sit with clothes on first
- Try during a preferred activity (tablet, book)
- Make it fun - sing songs, blow bubbles while sitting

### **Pees fine but won't poop on potty:**

- This is VERY common - poop takes longer to master
- Offer a diaper for poop if needed (then gradually transition)
- Ensure feet are supported (stool) for proper positioning

### **Regression after weeks of success:**

- Check for: new sibling, move, stress, illness
- Go back to more frequent reminders temporarily
- NEVER shame or punish - it makes it worse

### **Nighttime dryness:**

- Separate from daytime - can take months to years longer
- Use waterproof mattress cover and pull-ups at night
- Limit fluids 1 hour before bed
- Not developmental until age 5-6 for many children

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By Daniel Tesfamariam | Patience is the #1 potty training tool.